

INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION (HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION)

- QUICK REVISION GUIDE FOR UPSC PRELIMS 2026

Compiled for ABHISHA AI
by Abhishek Pathak

1 MAJOR SITES & UNIQUE FEATURES

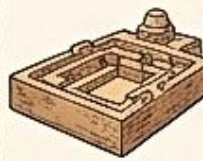


HARAPPA (Ravi, Pakistan)

- Granaries
- Coffin Burials
- 'H' Cemetery



MOHENJO-DARO (Indus, Pakistan)



- Great Bath
- Dancing Girl
- Bearded Man
- Great Granary



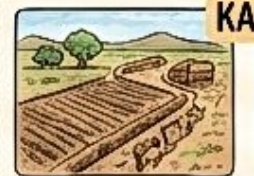
DHOLAVIRA (Gujarat)

- 3-part city
- Water Harvesting
- Signboard



LOTHAL (Gujarat)

- Artificial Dockyard
- Rice Husk
- Fire Altars
- Double Burial



KALIBANGAN (Rajasthan)

- Ploughed Field
- Wooden Drainage
- Camel Bones

2 TOWN PLANNING



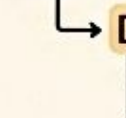
GRID PATTERN

- Streets at right angles



CITADEL (Upper) & LOWER TOWN

- Class division



DRAINAGE SYSTEM

- Covered
- Manholes
- Water-tight (Gypsum/Lime)



GRANARIES: Large storage

4 SCRIPT & SEALS



Pictographic Script



BOUSTROPHEDON (Right-Left, then Left-Right)



UNDECIPHERED

- Still a mystery



Common animals:

- Unicorn, Bull



Steatite material

3 TRADE & ECONOMY



- Trade with Mesopotamia (Cuneiform 'Meluha')

LOTHAL DOCKYARD

- Maritime trade hub



SEALS: For trade/stamping

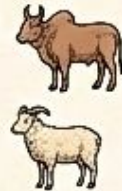
- Agricultural surplus

5 AGRICULTURE & DOMESTICATION



- Wheat
- Barley
- Cotton (Sindon)

- Humped Bull
- Sheep
- Goat



- Horse not regular part (Surkotada only)

6 RELIGIOUS PRACTICES



MOTHER GODDESS figurines (Fertility)

- Nature worship (Pipal)

PASHUPATI SEAL (Proto-Shiva)

- 3 faces, seated,

- Secular, no temples



6 RELIGIOUS PRACTICES



MOTHER GODDESS figurines (Fertility)

PASHUPATI SEAL (Proto-Shiva):

- 3 faces, seated, surrounded by animals



- Secular, no temples



Nature worship (Pipal)

7 HARAPPA VS. MOHENJO-DARO

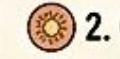
- Differences in burials, layout, layout, specific structures
- Specific structures (layout)

- Differences in burials, layout, layout, specific structures
- Specific built, rugosole, poild & layout

8 THEORIES FOR DECLINE



1. Ecological Imbalance (Fairservis)



2. Climate Change (Aridity)



3. Floods (Indus)



4. Aryan Invasion (Wheeler - discredited)



5. Tectonic Shifts

ANCIENT INDIA: VEDIC PERIOD TO MAHAJANAPADAS (UPSC 2026)

I. VEDIC PERIOD (c. 1500 - 600 BCE)

EARLY VEDIC (RIGVEDIC) AGE

POLITICAL ORGANIZATION

- Sabha (Council of Elders)
- Samiti (General Assembly)
- Vidatha
- Rajan (Tribal Chief)



SOCIAL STRUCTURE

- Varna System evolution
– Fluid in Early vs. Birth-based in Later
- Gotra
- Ashrama system

ECONOMIC LIFE

- Pastoralism to settled Agriculture
- Cows (Gavi) as wealth
- Iron ('Krishna Ayas')

RELIGIOUS CONCEPTS

- Indra, Agni, Varuna
- Rituals (Yajnas)
- Rise of Prajapati
- Vishnu, Rudra
- Upanishads



POSITION OF WOMEN

- Decline from high status

LATER VEDIC AGE

POLITICAL ORGANIZATION

- Sabha (Council of Elders)
- Samiti (General Assembly)
- Gotra
- Ashrama system



RELIGIOUS CONCEPTS

- Indra, Agni
- Varuna
- Rituals (Yajnas)
- Rise of Prajapati
- Vishnu
- Rudra
- Upanishads



POSITION OF WOMEN

- Decline from high status

IMPORTANT VEDIC TEXTS

- Rigveda (1028 hymns)
- Yajurveda
- Samaveda
- Atharvaveda
- Brahmanas
- Aranyakas



II. MAHAJANAPADAS AND RISE OF MAGADHA (c. 600 BCE onwards)

SIXTEEN MAHAJANAPADAS



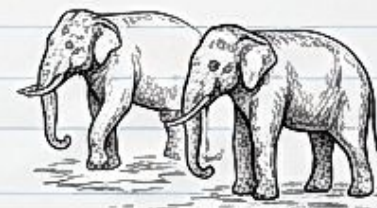
Capital	Capital
Magadha	Rajgriha/Pataliputra
Kashi	Varanasi
Vajji	Vaishali
Kosala	Shravasti
Gandhara	Taxila

REPUBLICS vs. MONARCHIES

- Key distinctions and Examples – Vajji, Malla as Gana-Sanghas
- Magadha, Kosala as Monarchies (- Magadha)

REASONS FOR MAGADHA'S RISE

- Iron Deposits (Rajgir)
- Elephant Army (large-scale use)
- River Advantages (Ganga, Son, Gandak)



IMPORTANT RULERS

- Bimbisara (Matrimonial alliances, Anga conquest)
- Ajatashatru (Vaishali & Kashi conquest, 1st Buddhist Council)

ADMINISTRATIVE SYSTEMS

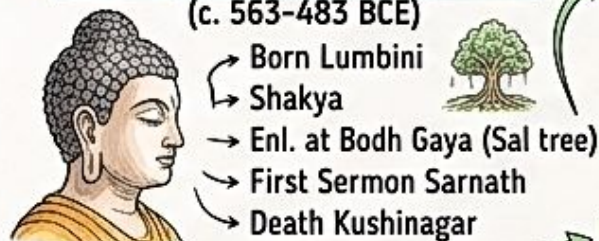
- Rise of bureaucracy
- Amatyas, Mahamatras
- mandatory Taxes (Bali)



UPSC CSE 2026 PRELIMS STUDY GUIDE

1. KEY TENTETS: BUDDHISM

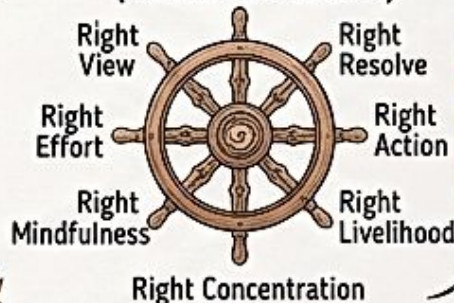
LIFE & TEACHINGS OF BUDDHA



FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS

1. Suffering (DUKKHA)
2. Cause: Desire (TAMHA)
3. Cessation possible
4. PATH (MAGGA)

EIGHTFOLD PATH (ASHTANGIKA MARGA)



NIRVANA

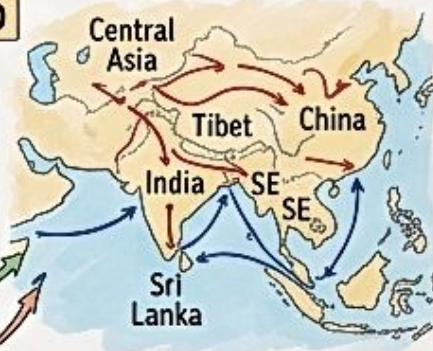
FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS

1. Suffering (DUKKHA)
2. Cause: Desire (TAMHA)
3. Cessation possible
4. PATH (MAGGA)



3. BUDDHIST COUNCILS & SPREAD

Council	Ruler	Venut
1st	Ajatashatru	Vinaya & Sutta compilation
2nd	Rajgriha	Vinaya & Sutta Pitaka elc3np Rajjgriha
4th	Kanishka	Mahayana-Hinayana split

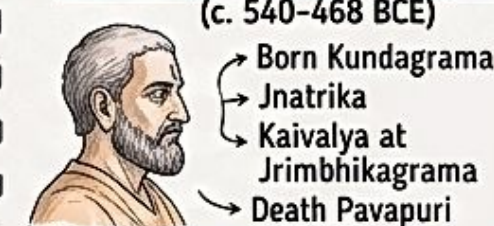


ASHOKA'S MISSIONS

JAINISM & BUDDHISM COMPREHENSIVE STUDY

2. KEY TENTETS: JAINISM

LIFE & TEACHINGS OF MAHAVIRA



EXTREME ASCETICISM

JAIN TRIRATNA (THREE JEWELS)

- Key for liberation:
- Right Faith
 - Right Knowledge
 - Right Conduct



FIVE MAHAVRATAS (VOWS)

1. Ahimsa (Non-violence)
2. Satya (Truth)
3. Asteya (Non-stealing)
4. Aparigraha (Non-possession)
5. BRAHMACHARYA (Celibacy - added by Mahavira)

DOCTRINES

- Anekantavada (Pluralism)
- Syadvada (Conditioned Predication)

KAIVALYA



HINAYANA vs MAHAYANA

HINAYANA (Theravada) vs MAHAYANA

- | | |
|---|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Buddha as human teacher / god Individual salvation / Bodhisattva ideal Less rituals Pali | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Buddha as human teacher / god Bodhisattva ideal More rituals, idol worship Sanskrit |
|---|--|

5. IMPACT ON SOCIETY & ART

Social: Equality, anti-caste

Arts: (like Sanchi) CHAITYAS VIHARAS

SCULPTURE SCHOOLS:

Gandhara (Greco-Buddhist, realistic)
Mathura (Indigenous, spotted red sandstone)
Amaravati (Marble, narrative)

EDUCATION: Universities like Nalanda

"GUPTA EMPIRE (GOLDEN AGE)" c. 319-550 CE

"Peak of Ancient Indian Civilization: Shift to decentralized rule, 'Indianization' of art, Sanskrit's Golden Era."

ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURE

- Style: Decentralized / Proto-Feudal. Conquered kings as *Samantas* (feudatories).
 - Titles: King as *Maharajadhiraja*, *Param-bhattaraka*.
 - Assisted by *Mantriparishad* (Council)
 - Key Officers: *Kumaramatyas* (High ranking cadre);
Sandhivigrahika (War & Peace);
Mahabaladhikrita (Commander)
 - Provincial Units → *Uparika*
Province → District → *Vishayapati*
Vithi → Gram
Village → *Gramika*
 - Guilds (*Shrenis*): Unique role in city admin.
Nagarasresthi (chief merchant) &
Sarthavaha (caravan leader) 
- Bhukti → Vishaya → Vithi → Gram
Province → *Vishayapati* Sub-district → *Gramika*

COINAGE SYSTEM

- Gold Coins (*Dinaras*): Largest number issued in ancient India.
 - "Indianized" designs. Common motifs: Archer, Veena player (Samudragupta), Lion slayer.
- Silver Coins (*Rupakas*): Introduced by Chandragupta II (after defeating Western Kshatrapas/Sakas).
- Copper Coins: Rare. Daily trade likely by barter or cowrie shells (noted by Fa-Hien). 

DEVELOPMENTS IN SCIENCE - ARYABHATA

- Aryabhata: Author of *Aryabhatiya* & *Surya Siddhanta*.
- Astronomy: Earth is spherical, rotates on its axis. Scientific explanation for eclipses. 
- Mathematics: Invented Decimal system and Zero concept. Calculated $\pi \approx 3.1416$.
- Metallurgy: Mehrauli Iron Pillar (Delhi) - rust-free for 1600+ years. 

LITERATURE - KALIDASA

- Style: Classical Sanskrit at its zenith; official court language. 
- Kalidasa ("Shakespeare of India"):
 - Plays: *Abhijnanashakuntalam*, *Malavikagnimitram*, *Vikramorvasiyam*.
 - Epic Poems: *Raghuvamsha*, *Kumarasambhava*.
 - Lyric Poetry: *Meghaduta*, *Ritusamhara*.
- Other Works: Shudraka's *Mrichchhakatika* (The Little Clay Cart); Vishakhadatta's *Mudrarakshasa*.
- Final compilation: Puranas, Ramayana, Mahabharata during this period.

ART AND ARCHITECTURE - TEMPLE BEGINNINGS

- Shift: Transition to structural stone temples from caves.
- Nagara Style seeds:
 - Stage 1: Flat-roofed square temples (e.g., Sanchi Temple 17).
 - Stage 2 (Addition): Shikhara (Tower).
Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh (UP) - first rudimentary shikhara.
- Brick Temples: Bhitargaon Temple (Kanpur).
- Sculpture: Sarnath School. "Spiritualism," "transparent drapery" (e.g., Seated Buddha). 



ECONOMY AND TRADE

- Agriculture: Backbone. Sudarshana Lake repair (Skandagupta).
- Trade:
 - External: Roman trade declined (4th c.). Southeast Asia (*Suvarnabhumi*) and China flourished.
 - Guilds (*Shrenis*): acted as banks, accepted deposits, powerful with own seals/laws. 
- Urban Decay: Fa-Hien noticed decay of Pataliputra, Mathura. Shift to rural, agrarian economy. 

DECLINE OF GUPTA EMPIRE...

- Slow fragmentation after Skandagupta (last great ruler).
- Causes:
 - Huna Invasions: Constant attacks, drained treasury. 
 - Internal Revolts: Feudatories (Maukharis, Maitrakas) declared independence.
 - Economic Weakness: Lost silk trade route, Land Grants (*Agraharas*) led to tax loss and feudalism rise.
 - Weak Successors.

COMPREHENSIVE NOTEBOOK ON THE SANGAM AGE (c. 3rd BCE - 3rd CE) & SOUTH INDIAN KINGDOMS

SANGAM LITERATURE (THE FOUNDATION)

- Nature: Akam (Love/Inner) & Puram (War/Outer/Ethics)
- The Three Sangams

Sangam	Patron	Location	Notable Works
Sangam	Murugan (Love/Inner)	Vanji/Karur	Earliest Tamil Grammar/Poetics
Sangam	Uraiyur (Poriar)	Puhar (Kaveripatnam)	Ettutogai (8 Anthologies)
Sangam	Variyur (Roma)	Madiyai	Silappathikaram (Ilango Adigal)

KEY TEXTS



Tolkappiyam
(Earliest Tamil Grammar/Poetics)



Ettutogai
(8 Anthologies)



Pattu-pattu
(10 Idylls)



Pathinenkilkanakku
(18 Minor Works - incl. Thirukkural)

- **EPICS:** Silappathikaram (Ilango Adigal), Manimekalai (Sathanar)



THREE SOUTH INDIAN KINGDOMS (MUVENTHAR)



CHERAS

Capital: Vanji/Karur
Port: Musiri/Tondi

RULER: Senguttuvan
(Pattini Cult, 'Red Chera')

CHOLAS

Capital: Uraiyur
Port: Puhar (Kaveripattinam)

RULER: Karikala
(Built Kallanai Dam, Kaveri delta control)

PANDYAS

Capital: Madurai
Port: Korkai

RULER: Nedun-cheliyan (Battle of Talaiyalanganam, Patrons of Sangams)

CULTURAL & SOCIAL LIFE

FIVE THINAI (ECO-REGIONS)



Kurinji
(Hilly - Murugan, Hunter)

Mullai
(Pastoral - Vishnu, Cattle)

Marutham
(Agriculture - Indra, Farmer)

Neithal
(Coastal - Varunan, Fishing)

Palai
(Desert - Korravai, Robbery)

ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURE

Mandalam
(Province)

Nadu
(District)

Ur
(Village)

THE KING & COUNCILS

• Aimperungulu
(Five Great Councils):

- Ministers, Priests
- Envoys
- Commanders
- Spies

• **TAXATION:** Vari (general tax), Iravu (forced tribute)

TRADE WITH THE ROMANS



- **EVIDENCE:** Arikamedu finds (coins, glass), Yavanas (guards/traders)
- **IMPORTS:** Wine, Gold, Silver
- **EXPORTS:** Pepper (Black Gold), Pearls, Ivory, Textiles
- **SOCIAL:** Profession-based divisions (Arasar, Anthanar, Vellalar), Sati existed but women respected (Poets like Avvaiyar)
- **RELIGION:** Murugan as Seyon, Hero Stones (Nadukal) for fallen warriors
- **ECONOMY:** Agriculture (Rice staple), Cotton weaving (Uraiyur)

DELHI SULTANATE (1206-1526 AD) | A COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE FOR UPSC PRELIMS 2026

I. THE FIVE DYNASTIES (CHRONOLOGY)

SLAVE DYNASTY (MAMLUK) (1206-1290 AD):

- Key Ruler: Iltutmish, Balban
- Focus: Consolidation



KHILJI DYNASTY (1290-1320 AD):

- Key Ruler: Alauddin Khilji
- Focus: Expansion & Reforms



TUGHLAQ DYNASTY (1320-1414 AD):

- Key Ruler: Muhammad bin Tughlaq, Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- Max Reach & Experiments



SAYYID DYNASTY (1414-1451 AD):

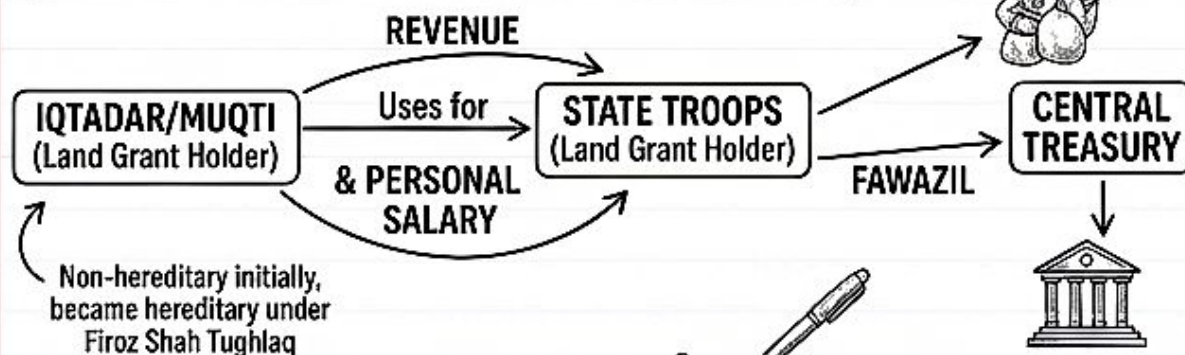
- Local Rule near Delhi



LODI DYNASTY (1451-1526 AD):

- 1st Afghan Dynasty
- Ended with Battle of Panipat

II. ADMINISTRATIVE SYSTEM: THE IQTA SYSTEM



III. ALA-UD-DIN KHILJI'S MARKET REFORMS



FIXED PRICES
(Essential goods & luxury items)



SHAHNA-I-MANDI
(Market Superintendent)



THREE SEPARATE MARKETS
(Grains, High-quality cloth, Horses/Cattle/Slaves)



GOVERNMENT WAREHOUSES & RATIONING
during shortage

- **GOVERNMENT WAREHOUSES & RATIONING** during shortage
- **DIWAN-I-MUSTAKHRAJ** (Revenue Collection Dept)

IV. MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ'S EXPERIMENTS & ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS

- **CAPITAL TRANSFER** (Delhi to Daulatabad) (Failed due to logistical problems)
- **TOKEN CURRENCY** (Copper/Brass coins) (Failed, led to counterfeiting)
- **KHURASAN & QARACHIL EXPEDITIONS** (Ambitious, expensive military failures)
- **DIWAN-I-AMIR-KOHI** (Agricultural Development Dept)

V. DELHI SULTANATE ARCHITECTURE: KEY FEATURES & EXAMPLES

- **INDO-ISLAMIC STYLE**
(True Arch, Dome, Minaret, Use of Mortar)

Tughlaq Style:
Tormeeet for Akrch

Sloping walls (Batter)
Lodi Style: Double Dome,
Octagonal Tombs

- **KEY MONUMENTS:**



QUTUB MINAR
• True Arch
• Minaret
• Started by Aibak
• Completed by Iltutmish



ALAI DARWAZA
(Horse-shoe Arch, True Dome, Red Sandstone & Marble Inlay, Built by Alauddin Khilji)



QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM MOSQUE
(Early reuse of existing temple materials)



SULTAN GHARI
(1st Islamic Tomb in India, for Prince Nasiruddin Mahmud)

KEY DEPARTMENTS

Diwan-i-Wizarat (Finance), Diwan-i-Arz (Military), Diwan-i-Insha (State Correspondence), Diwan-i-Rasalat (Religious/Foreign), Diwan-i-Bandagan (Slaves)



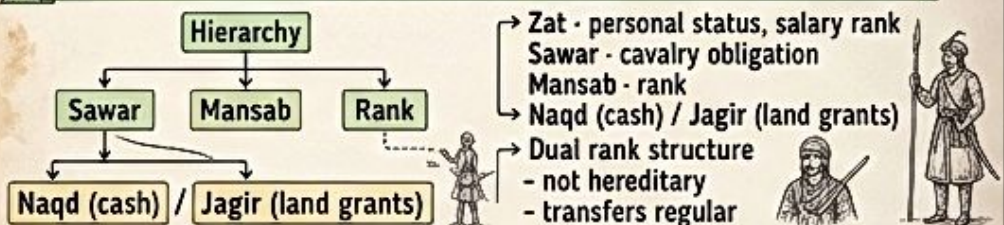
MUGHAL EMPIRE



BABUR'S CONQUEST & ESTABLISHMENT (1526-1530)

- **Key Innovations:** Introduction of *topkhana* (artillery) and gunpowder
- **First Battle of Panipat (1526)**
 - defeat of Ibrahim Lodi
 - use of Tulughma (flanking) and Araba (carts)
- **Battle of Khanwa (1527)**
 - vs. Rana Sanga
 - took title *Ghazi*
- **Battle of Chanderi (1528)**
 - vs. Took title *Ghazi*
- **Battle of Ghagra (1529)**
 - vs. Rana Sanga Vari

AKBAR'S ADMINISTRATION: THE MANSABDARI SYSTEM



REVENUE SYSTEM: TODAR MAL REFORMS (ZABTI/DAHSHALA)

- Zabti or Dahshala System (1580)**
- Based on average yield of last 10 years
 - Replaced older systems
 - Precise measurement using Tanab (bamboo sticks with iron rings)
- Land Classification (by fertility)**
- | Polaj | Parauti | Chachar |
|-----------|------------|-----------|
| annual | fallow 1-2 | 3-4 years |
| Paraur | Chachar | Banjar |
| 1-1 years | 3-4 years | 5+ years |

JAHANGIR & SHAH JAHAN PERIOD (1605-1658)



Jahangir (1605-1627)
"Zanjir-i-Adal (Chain of Justice)"
 • Consolidated empire
 • Rise of Marathas (Malik Ambar)
 • Du-aspa Sih-aspa system



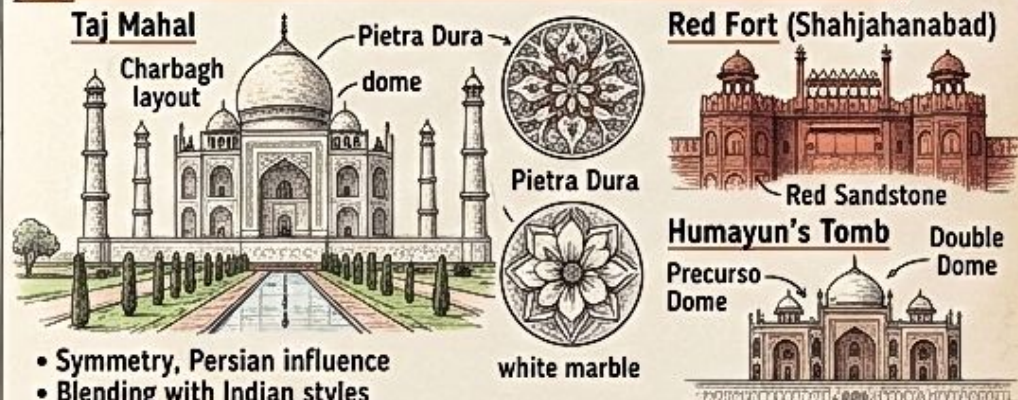
Shah Jahan (1627-1658)
"Golden Age of Architecture"
 • Expanded into Deccan
 • Monthly Scale (Mahana) for admin
 • Brief Kandahar recovery

AURANGZEB'S POLICIES (1658-1707)

- **Maximum Expansion, Then Decline**
- "Deccan Ulcer": 25 years in Deccan drained treasury, weakened North
- Reimposed Jizya (1679)
- Discontinued *Jharokha Darshan*
- **Conflicts:** Revolts by Jats, Satnamis, Sikhs (Guru Gobind Singh), Marathas (Shivaji)



MUGHAL ARCHITECTURE: KEY CHARACTERISTICS



CAUSES OF MUGHAL DECLINE (POST-1707)

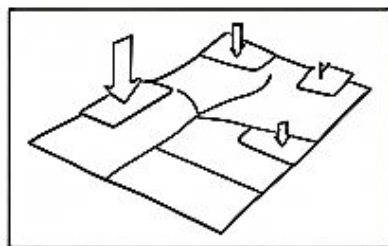
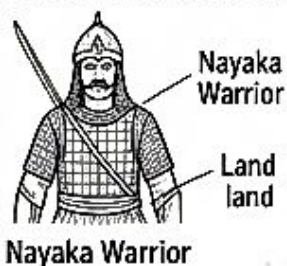
- **Jagirdari Crisis:** shortage of good land (Jagirs), leading to noble rivalry
- **Succession Wars:** no clear law, conflicts after every emperor
- **Weak Successors (Later Mughals):** puppets of powerful nobles (e.g. Sayyid Brothers)
- **Economic Strain:** prolonged wars, treasury drained
- **Economic Strain:** prolonged wars, treasury drained
- **Rise of Regional Powers:** independent kingdoms like Awadh, Bengal, Hyderabad, Marathas
- **External Invasions:** Nadir Shah (1739), Ahmad Shah Abdali

ABHISHA AI BY ABHISHEK PATHAK

PROJECT: VIJAYANAGARA vs BAHMANI KINGDOMS

Vijayanagara Empire (The Nayankara System)

- Centralized rule with powerful 'Rayas'
- 'Nayakas' managed provinces (land grants for military service)
- Maintained fixed troops and paid annual tribute



Common Conflict (The Raichur Doab)

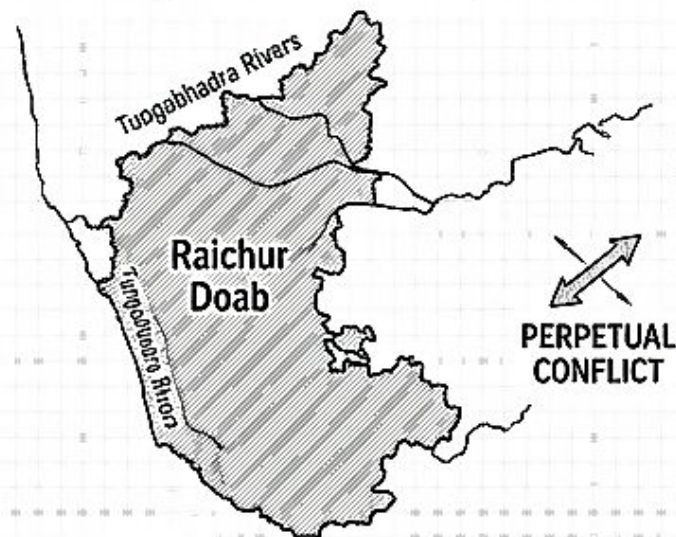
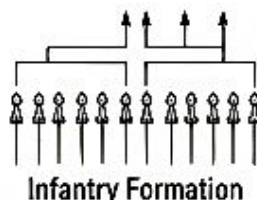


Diagram 4.2: Hampi

Military Organization.

Vijayanagara:

- Massive Infantry & Cavalry
- Early integration of firearms
- Turkish musketeers in the ranks



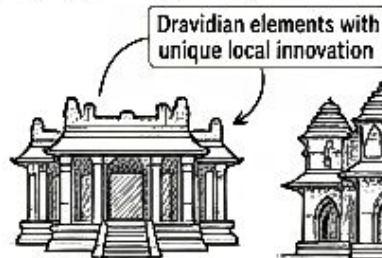
Architecture – Hampi (Vijayanagara)



Virupaksha Temple



Stone Chariot



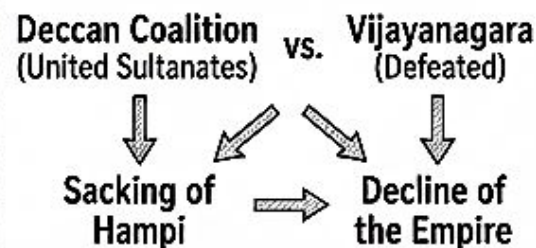
Kalyana Mandapa (Marriage Hall)



Lotus Mahal (Indo-Islamic Blend)

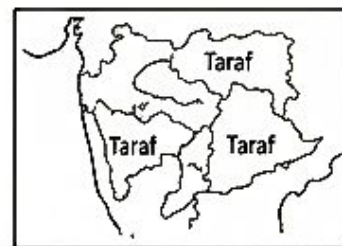
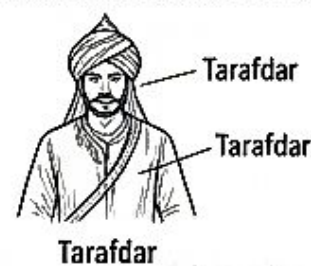
The Turning Point.

The Battle of Talikota (1565)



Bahmani Kingdom (The Tarafdari System)

- Centralized authority eventually fragmented
- 'Tarafs' (provinces) governed by 'Tarafdars'
- Decentralization led to the five Deccan Sultanates



Military Organization.

Bahmani:

- Advantage in Cavalry & Artillery
- Standing army maintained
- Imported Persian & Turkish experts



Trade Relations.

GLOBAL COMMERCE HUBS

Feature	Vijayanagara	Bahmani
Major Ports	(Bhatkal, Honavar)	(Chaul, Dabhol)
Key Exports	(Spices, Textiles)	(Rice, Iron)
Key Imports	(Horses, Silk, Gold)	(Horses, Arms)
Partners	(Portuguese, Arabs, Chinese)	(Persians, Arabs)

Trade Relations

BHAKTI & SUFI MOVEMENTS

Nirguna vs. Saguna Traditions

Nirguna

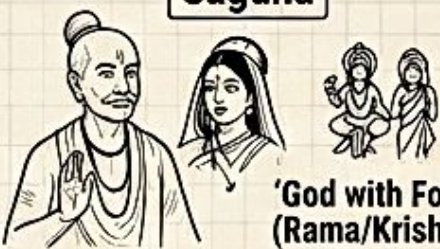


'Formless God'

KABIR

- Worship of **Abstract God**
- Rejection of Idol Worship & Caste

Saguna



'God with Form (Rama/Krishna)'

TULSIDAS and MIRABAI

- Devotion to Incarnations (Avatars)
- Use of **Bhajans & Awadhi Literature**

SUFI SILSILAS (Orders)

Chishti Silsila



- Founded by **Moinuddin Chishti**
- Emphasized Poverty & Sama (Music)
- Dattached from State

Suhrawardi Silsila



- Founded by **Shaik Shahabuddin**
- Accepted State Patronage
- Lived in Comfort

IMPACT ON SOCIETY & REGIONAL SPREAD

- Devotion to common language
- Challenged caste system
- Promoted syncretism (Ganga-Jamuni Culture)

ABHISHA AI

ABHISHA AI

Source: Abhisha AI Research

UPSC Prelims 2026 Key Data

Grid: 5x5mm

Grid: 5x5mm

UPSC Prelims 2026 Key Data

MEDIEVAL TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE STYLE FOCUS

NAGARA STYLE (North India)

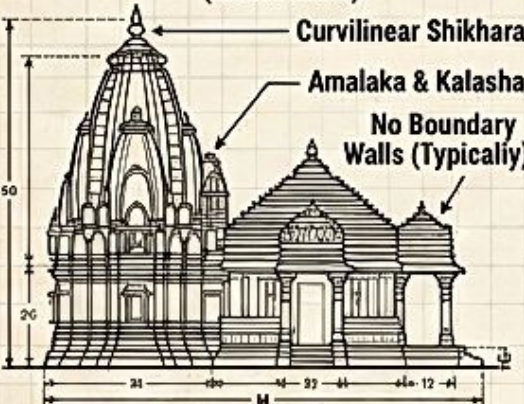


Diagram 8.1: Nagara vs. Dravida Spire Evolution

DRAVIDA STYLE (South India)

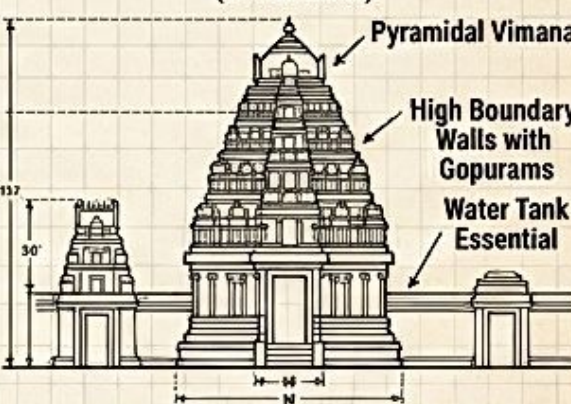


Diagram 8.1: Nagara vs. Dravida Spire Evolution

THE THREE PRIMARY STYLES

Feature	Nagara (North)	Dravida (South)	Vesara (Hybrid)
Shikhara/Vimana	Curvilinear Shikhara	Pyramidal Vimana	Combination of both
Boundary Walls	Usually no boundary walls	High boundary walls + Gopurams	Varies
Water Tank	Not mandatory	Highly essential	Present in later stages
Examples	Khajuraho, Sun Temple	Brihadisvara, Meenakshi	Hoysala Temples, Badami

CORE TEMPLE COMPONENTS

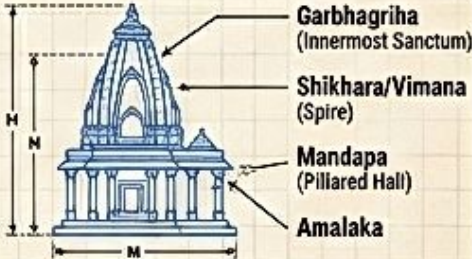


Diagram 8.1: Nagara vs. Dravida Spire Evolution

IMPORTANT TEMPLES AND PATRONS

Temple	Style	Patron/Dynasty	Key Feature
Kanderiya Mahadeva	Nagara	Chandela Dynasty	Erohc sculptures; Panchazsts
Brihadicvara (Thanjavur)	Dravida	Rajeraja I (Chola)	World's first granite temple
Chennakeshava (Belur)	Vesara	Vishnuvardhana (Hoysals)	Intricate sossptone carvings
Sun Temple (Konark)	Nagara	Narasimhadeva I (Ganga)	Designed as a giant chariot

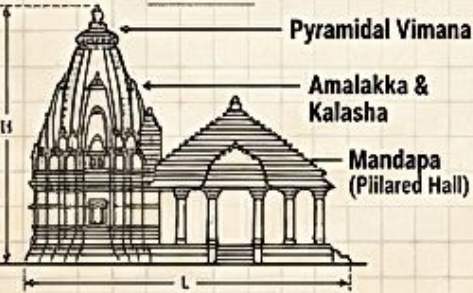
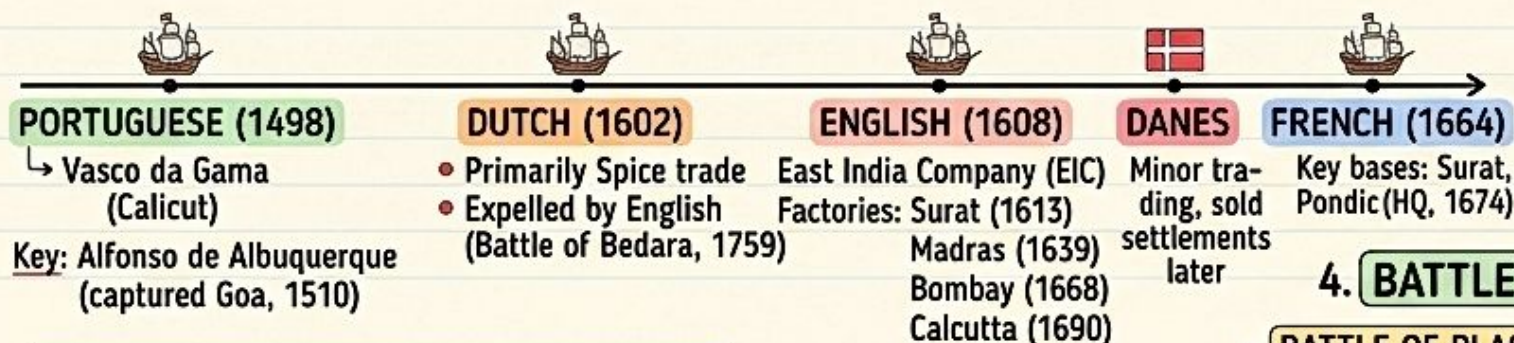


Diagram 8.1: Nagara vs. Dravida Spire Evolution

UPSC Prelims 2026 Key Data

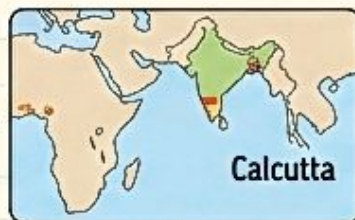
Grid: 5x5mm

1. SEQUENCE OF ARRIVAL (1498-1664)



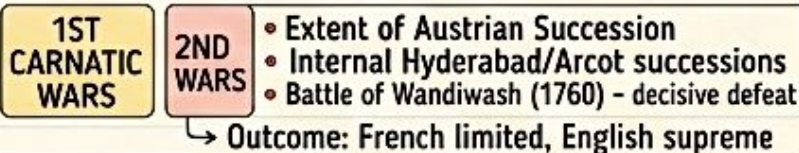
2. TRADING COMPANIES & FACTORIES

COMPANY	FIRST FACTORY	MAJOR HUBS
Portuguese	Calicut	
Dutch	Masulipatnam	
English	Surat	
French	Surat	

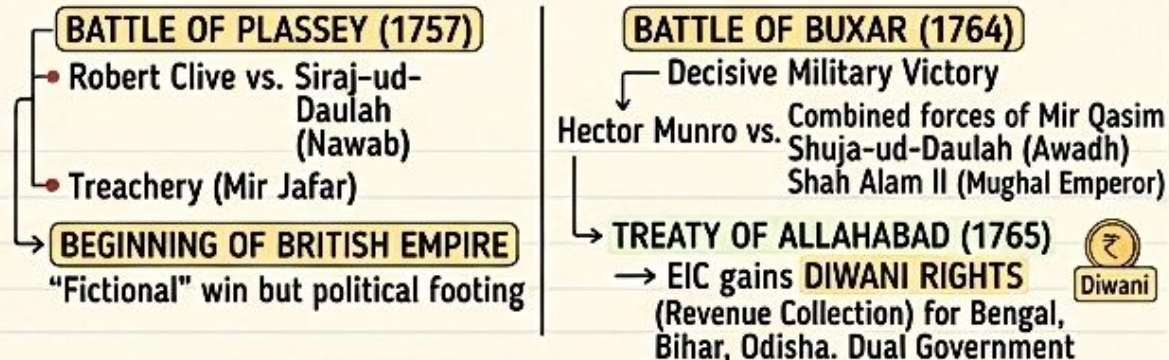


3. CARNATIC WARS (1746-1763)

ANGLO-FRENCH RIVALRY IN INDIA

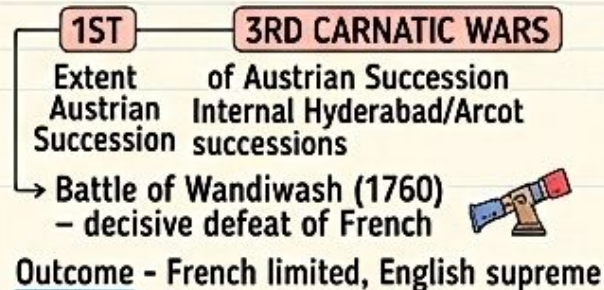


4. BATTLES FOR BENAL: CONSOLIDATION



3. CARNATIC WARS (1746-1763)

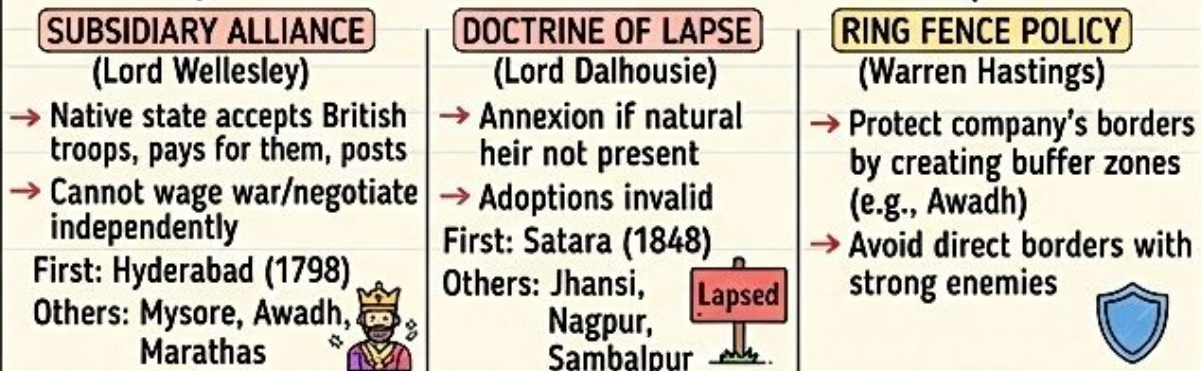
ANGLO-FRENCH RIVALRY IN INDIA



BATTLE OF BUXAR (1764)



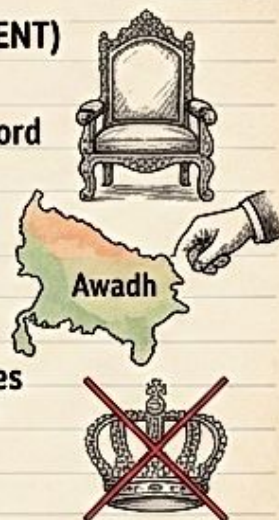
BRITISH EXPANSION POLICIES



THE REVOLT OF 1857: FIRST WAR OF INDEPENDENCE (FOR UPSC PRELIMS 2026)

I. POLITICAL CAUSES (RULING CLASS RESENTMENT)

- **DOCTRINE OF LAPSE:** Annexed states (Satara, Sambalpur, Jhansi, Nagpur) if no natural heir (Lord Dalhousie). Sketch of an ornate empty throne.
- **ANNEXATION OF AWADH (1856):** Grounds of "maladministration" shocked populace and sepoys. (Many from Awadh).
- **ABOLITION OF TITLES:** Refused to recognize titles of Nana Sahib (adopted son), diminished status of Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar. Royal emblems with a line through them.



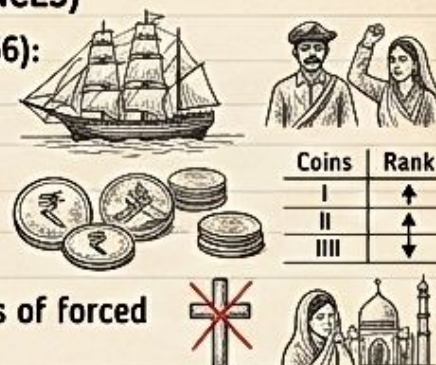
II. ECONOMIC CAUSES (DESTRUCTION OF ECONOMY)

- **HIGH LAND REVENUE:** Systems like Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, Mahalwari imposed heavy taxes. Peasant indebtedness. Peasants working in a field tax bags.
- **DE-INDUSTRIALIZATION:** Influx of British machine-made goods. Local handicrafts and textile industries destroyed. A spinning wheel next to factory smoke stacks.
- **DRAIN OF WEALTH:** Constant transfer of resources to Britain (without return).



III. MILITARY CAUSES (SEPOY GRIEVANCES)

- **GENERAL SERVICE ENLISTMENT ACT (1856):** Required sepoys to serve overseas (loss of caste fears for Hindus).
- **DISCRIMINATION:** Lower pay for Indian sepoys compared to British soldiers. No promotions to higher ranks.
- **RELIGIOUS INTERFERENCE:** Growing fears of forced conversion to Christianity.



IV. IMMEDIATE TRIGGER: THE ENFIELD RIFLE & GREASED CARTRIDGES



Cartridges rumored with COW & PIG FAT grease. Had to be bitten off before loading. Offended Hindu & Muslim religious sentiments.

MANGAL PANDEY: Started defiance at Barrackpore (34th N.I.) on March 29, 1857.



V. IMPORTANT LEADERS & CENTERS



RANI LAKSHMIBAI
Fought valiantly.
Hugh Rose: "best and"

TANTIA TOPE
Brilliant strategist,
guerrilla warfare.

CENTRE	LEADER	BRITISH OFFICER
DELHI	Bahadur Shah Zafar (Nominal) Gen Bakht Khan (Actual)	- John Nicholson
KANPUR	Nana Sahib, Tantia Tope	- Colin Campbell
LUCKNOW	Begum Hazrat Mahal	- Colin Campbell
JHANSI	Rani Lakshmibai	- Hugh Rose
ARRAH	Kunwar Singh	- William Taylor
BAREILLY	Khan Bahadur Khan	- Colin Campbell

VI. GEOGRAPHIC SCOPE & PARTICIPATION

- **PRIMARILY CONFINED TO NORTH & CENTRAL INDIA.** Southern, Western (Bombay), Eastern (Bengal) largely peaceful or supported British.

NON-PARTICIPANTS (LOYAL):

Sikh Princes, Nizam of Hyderabad, Scindia of Gwalior (troops revolted, he loyal).

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS REFORM MOVEMENTS IN 19TH CENTURY INDIA

Comprehensive Guide for UPSC Prelims 2026



INTRODUCTION

A wave of movements for social and religious reform, aiming to correct issues and promote modern, rational values.

BRAHMO SAMAJ (1828)

- Founder: Raja Rammohan Roy
- Core Beliefs:
 - Monotheism (Ekeshwarvad)
 - Rejecting idolatry and meaningless rituals
 - Based on Upanishads
- Key Issues: Crusade against Sati (leading to 1829 ban)
 - Child marriage
 - Caste system
- Evolution:
 - Tattvabodhini Sabha (Debendranath Tagore joined in 1842)
 - Split 1: Keshab Chandra Sen formed Brahmo Samaj of India (1866)
 - Split 2: Sadharan Brahmo Samaj (1878) due to Sen's daughter's marriage



ARYA SAMAJ (1875)

- Founder: Swami Dayanand Saraswati
- Ideology: 'Back to the Vedas'
 - Rejecting Puranas and idol worship
 - Revivalist but modern outlook on education
- Key Contributions:
 - Shuddhi Movement (reconversion)
 - Focus on social service
 - Promoting widow remarriage
 - Opposing untouchability
- Education: Established DAV (Dayanand Anglo-Vedic) schools
 - Internal split: 'College Party' (Lala Hansraj) favored modern English education vs. 'Gurukul Party' (Swami Shraddhanand) for traditional Vedic studies
- Notable Work: Satyarth Prakash

ALIGARH MOVEMENT

- Leader: Sir Syed Ahmed Khan
- Ideology: Reconciling Islam with modern Western science and education
 - Interpreting Quran through reason and science (Ijtihad)
- Focus: Opposed Parda system, polygamy, easy divorce
 - Advocated modern education for Muslims to join public services
- Key Institution: Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College (1875), later Aligarh Muslim University (1920)

YOUNG BENGAL MOVEMENT (late 1820s)

- Leader: Henry Vivian Derozio (Hindu College teacher)
- Ideology:
 - Inspired by the French Revolution
 - Radical values of liberty, equality, and free thinking
- Nature: Intellectual revolt
 - Attacked old customs and superstitions
 - Advocated female education
 - Demanded entry for Indians into higher government posts
- Limitations:
 - Radical and far ahead of its time
 - Lacked links with the common masses
 - Short-lived intense phase

IMPACT ON INDIAN SOCIETY

- Religious Reform: Shift from blind faith to rationalism and humanism
 - Weakened traditional orthodoxy
- Social Change: Legal action against Sati (1829), Infanticide, Slavery
 - Widow Remarriage Act (1856); Improved women's status through education
- Rise of Nationalism: Created self-respect and pride
 - Challenged cultural dominance of the West
 - Provided the intellectual foundation for the freedom struggle
- Educational Advancements: Widespread establishment of schools and colleges
 - Created an educated middle-class intelligentsia

NOTEBOOK: INDIAN NATIONAL MOVEMENT (1885-1947) - UPSC PRELIMS 2026 GUIDELINES

ABHISHA AI
by Abhishek Pathak

FORMATION OF INC (1885)



A.O. Hume



W.C. Bonnerjee



72 delegates

'Safety Valve Theory?'

MODERATE PHASE DEMANDS (1885-1905)

- Expansion of Councils
- Concurrent ICS exams
- Pro-industry policies
- Civil liberties



EXTREMIST PHASE LEADERS (1905-1920)



'Swaraj is my Birthright'

- 'Swaraj is my Birthright' slogan
- Active methods

SWADESHI MOVEMENT (1905-1911)



- Partition of Bengal map
- Boycott of British Goods
- Promotion of Indigenous Industries
- National Education



MODERATE PHASE > (1885-1905)

- Expansion of Councils
- Concurrent ICS exams
- Pro-industry policies
- Civil liberties



SWADESHI MOVEMENT (1905-1911)



- Partition of Bengal map
- Boycott of British Goods
- Promotion of Indigenous Industries
- National Education



HOME RULE MOVEMENT (1916)



- Tilak & Besant leagues
- 'Self-Government'
- Lucknow Pact 1916
- reunification



HOME RULE MOVEMENT (1916)

- Tilak & Besant leagues
- 'Self-Government'
- Lucknow Pact 1916 reunification



ABHISHA AI

GANDHIAN MOVEMENTS (1917-1947)

Early Satyagrahas

- Champaran 1917
- Kheda 1918
- Ahmedabad 1918



NON-COOPERATION (1920)

- Rowlatt Act context
- Khilafat issue
- Chauri Chaura 1922 withdrawal



CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE (1930)

- Dandi March
- Salt Satyagraha
- Karachi Session 1931



QUIT INDIA (1942)

- Failure of Cripps
- 'Do or Die'
- Leaderless mass revolt



Ratnayya Jagadish (Cf.)

ABHISHA AI
by Abhishek Pathak

ROLE OF REVOLUTIONARY MOVEMENTS

- HRA
- HSRA
- Chandrashekhar Azad
- Kakori
- Central Assembly
- Chittagong Armory Raid



SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE & INA

- Tripuri crisis
- Forward Bloc
- INA Formation with Mohan Singh
- Bose in Singapore
- 'Delhi Chalo'
- Red Fort Trials



CABINET MISSION PLAN (1946)

- Federal structure
- Weak center
- Grouping of Provinces
- Constituent Assembly



MOUNTBATTEN PLAN (JUNE 3, 1947)

- Partition plan
- Creation of India and Pakistan
- Date advanced to Aug 15



INDIA'S CONSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENTS: EVOLUTION TOWARD INDEPENDENCE

(FOR UPSC PRELIMS 2026)

PART I: THE COMPANY RULE (1773-1858)

REGULATING ACT 1773



- FIRST step to regulate EIC affairs
- Centralization begins
- GG of Bengal created (Warren Hastings)
- Subordination of Bombay & Madras
- Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)



PITT'S INDIA ACT 1784

'Double Government'

DUAL SYSTEM:

- Commercial (Court of Directors) & Political (Board of Control)
- First reference to 'British possessions in India'

CHARTER ACTS (Every 20 Yrs)

1813

- Abolished EIC monopoly (except Tea & Trade with China)
- Rs 1 lakh for Education

1833

- FINAL STEP: GG of India (William Bentinck)
- EIC purely administrative body
- Attempt at Open Civil Service (Macaulay Committee)

1853

- SEPARATED LEGISLATIVE & EXECUTIVE functions
- Introduce open competition (Macaulay Committee)

PART II: THE CROWN RULE (1858-1947)

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT 1858



- End of Company Rule
- GG became VICEROY (Lord Canning)
- New office: Secretary of State (SOS) in London, aided by Council of India

INDIAN COUNCILS ACTS

1861

- Portfolio System
- Decentralization begins
- Indians associated with law-making

1892

- Limited nomination to councils
- Discuss Budget

1909

- (MORLEY-MINTO)
- SEPARATE ELECTORATES for MUSLIMS (Legalized communalism)
- Limited official majority in councils

MAJOR REFORM ACTS

GOI ACT 1919

(MONTAGU-CHELMSFORD)

- DIARCHY at PROVINCES: Transferred & Reserved
- Bicameral Central Legislature
- Direct Elections introduced
- Central & Provincial subjects separated

GOI ACT 1935

PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY

(Dyarchy abolished in Provinces, introduced at Centre - never implemented)

- Three Lists: Federal, Provincial, Concurrent
- Residuary Powers with Viceroy
- Set up: Federal Court (1937), Reserve Bank of India (1935)

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT 1947



- India independent & sovereign (Aug 15, 1947)
- Partition of India & Pakistan
- Abolished Secretary of State
- End of British Paramountcy
- Constituent Assemblies made sovereign

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